

Niyah Case Study

Project Context

In India, the cumulative household holdings of gold are estimated to be 30,000 tonnes, valued between \$3 Trillion to \$5 Trillion. As gold prices rose, Indian government approved the hallmarking of 9 karat gold in July 2024. This created a space for a more affordable variant of gold jewellery. This led to creation of Niyah by two ambitious founders, who hired me as their founding marketing person, with the goal of creating a unique positioning and carve a niche against the dominating jewellery players.

Problem

Jewellery is currently either for occasions or fast fashion artificial jewellery.

Gold Jewellery [22K] is associated with Weddings, Investment and Cultural Security.

Artificial Jewellery doesn't feel special, doesn't inspire or instill confidence, and can cause infections at times.

This creates a **design, weight, and wearability problem** for daily use.

Opportunity

Urban women are now buying jewellery for daily wear, especially for office and social settings. They do not want the designs that are wedding oriented. [Yellow, heavy designs and asset-like jewellery]

My Role

1. Lead GTM, brand, and growth strategy
2. Worked directly with founders to craft positioning, vision and launch of brand
3. Owned both thinking + execution as the founding marketer and first team member.

Jobs to be done (for Customer)

"I want jewellery I can wear every day that looks elegant and modern without paying wedding- jewellery level prices."

"Help me look put-together, modern, and elegant every day"

Primary ICP

Urban Working Women. Have a sense of taste and fashion. Are owners of Micheal Kors and other branded products. Own an iPhone or aspire to have one. Those who prefer Sephora over Nykaa.

▼ ICP Detail

Female, 27-40

Living in a Metro city / small city but independent in expenses.

Could be single, married or dating. Does not have kids in most cases.

Education: Graduate or Post Graduate

Income Level: 10 LPA & Above

Goals: Luxury Goods, Foreign Vacations, The Good Life

Sources of Information: Instagram, Whatsapp

Challenges: Wants so many things but limited money, trying to balance work, friends, personal life and looking good at the same time.

Pain Points: Needs multiple kinds of outfits for multiple occasions and matching jewellery and accessories is a pain. Wants to grow in her career and look after health and life the good life.

Objections to the Sale: Wants the handbag / watch / trip with friends also at the same time.

Role in the purchase process: Decision maker. May consult a friend, but parents aren't consulted.

Content Consumption: Follows a lot of Styling Influencers.

Secondary ICP

Gifting Buyers (Men buying for their partners/siblings and Women buying for their girl friends)

Want something special but not overwhelming. [Not a Wedding Ring but maybe Diamond Earrings]

Not Our Target ICP [To be excluded]

1. 45+ Women who care about purity of gold.
2. Wedding Jewellery Buyers.
3. 45+ Men who look at gold as an investment for their child.
4. People who care about diamonds being natural.

Learnings so far:

1. Big Jewellers have 9KT as an option, but not a priority for them. Also brand dilution [20K INR customer vs 1L customer]
2. Many women feel 9K is inferior [Like an iPhone Mini / Tata Nano], definitely brings status down compared to up. Better to have artificial variety than own lower karat.



Insight: We cannot compete on Gold. Purity, buyback value are "rational" discussions. Designs and diamonds are emotional discussions. We're selling **Everyday Diamond Jewellery** and we are using 9KT Gold to make it more affordable.

Solving for 9KT Inferiority can be done by focusing on durability of 9KT gold. It retains form and bends the least compared to 22K Gold which is soft. Hard & Durable 9KT Gold / Shape retaining 9KT Gold can be used as an additional feature, but not the hero.

Market Pain Points & Urgency

Are potential customers actively searching for solutions?

Yes, demi luxury is picking up. Palmonas, Giva, Bluestone have popped up as “non jewellers” Jewellery shops. Design first, not gold first like Tanishq, Joyalukkas etc. Palmonas is valued at >500 Cr.

Are they currently spending money to solve this problem?

They are. It is disposable income going into everyday office look and the weekend look. Accessories like Bags, Watches > 10K INR are normalised. Sneakers and Heels >5K are also normalised. Diamond Jewellery at 25K INR will be a steal deal.

WHY NOW?

1. Gold prices have increased by 100% in the last 365 days. 150,000 / 10g for 22K means 22K is out of range for a lot of people. Lab Grown Diamonds are making diamonds more accessible.
2. Consumption trends are shifting towards more variety and fast fashion [Each woman owns 3x more pairs of shoes and jewellery than they used to 10 years ago.], people now want more pieces of moderately expensive jewellery rather than one super expensive set that they rarely wear. This is the best time to launch *everyday diamond jewellery*.
3. Hedonism and self love have gained significant. As the number of women in workforce increases, their spends on self are also increasing. They also live an office first life compared to occassion first life 20 years ago. [in India]

Product Strategy

Product Definition: Everyday Diamond Jewellery

1. 9K Gold is an enabler, not the hero
2. Lightweight, elegant, modern
3. Designed for repeat and regular wear.

Product Principles

- Minimal
- Stackable
- Office appropriate
- Comfortable for long hours

Pricing & Value Perception Strategy

Diamonds. Design. Daily.

Diamonds: The number of diamonds. The Cut. The colour. The quality

Design: Hype. Description. Inspiration. Story behind the design.

Daily: Light, Comfortable, Elegant. Pairable with multiple types of clothing / colours [Not All, we want them to own more than one set of Niyah based on design and pairing]

Core Range: INR 25,000 - 50,000. [Some Exceptionals are "Price on Request / >100,000"]

Internally, we have to remember: "This competes with handbags, phones and watches, not gold jewellery or gold coins"

Positioning

Category Creation

We are not selling "Gold Jewellery" or "9KT Gold Jewellery" or "Affordable Gold Jewellery"

We are creating:



Everyday Diamond Jewellery for Modern Woman

Messaging Pillars

1. **Designed, Not Bulky:** Lightweight elegance that fits modern life.
2. **Diamonds for Every Day:** Not locked in a locker. Worn daily.
3. **Made for You, Not Traditions:** Personal style > inherited rules.
4. **Smart Luxury:** Looks premium, priced thoughtfully.
5. Named like modern art. Each SKU feels aspirational, personal and special.
Examples below.

▼ In Constellation: [Expand]

This piece is formed through togetherness. Individual stones come close, not to compete, but to create something fuller in their proximity. Each element keeps its clarity, yet the impact comes from how they align and support one another. Light moves across the surface in small conversations, never isolated, always connected. In Constellation is about presence multiplied. A form that shines because nothing stands alone.

▼ Held in Continuum: [Expand]

This ring is a single, uninterrupted thought.

Diamonds trace one side in a soft procession, never demanding attention, only offering presence. The curve feels intentional, almost meditative, like a line drawn slowly until it becomes complete. There is no beginning that announces itself, no ending that insists on closure.

Held in Continuum speaks to constancy. To the kind of commitment that does not perform, but endures. It holds emotion the way a steady hand holds silence, with care, with patience, with trust.

Worn daily, it becomes less an ornament and more a feeling you carry forward.

Channel Strategy

Phase 1: Website + Selective Offline Touchpoints

Pop-ups in Premium Malls, Appointment Based Try Ons, Premium Gated Societies

Goal : Get Customer Feedback, Positioning, know their reasons to buy / not buy.

Shorter Feedback Loop compared to social media.

Phase 2: Instagram Organic + Paid Ads + Influencer Collaborations

Use High Quality Graphics, Shoots with real pieces, User Generated Content by Influencers, Testimonials by customers who are visibly stylish. [Influencers, Confident and good looking people]

Phase 3: Physical Store

An Experience of Buying something premium. Not your standard Jewellery Shop that displays designs and lets you buy. A personal assisted experience where they ask you questions about your personality and then lead you to the designs that align with your persona.

Marketing Strategy

Awareness [Top of the Funnel]

Instagram, LinkedIn, Founder Led Growth.

Styling Reels + Influencer Partnerships

Creating the desire to wear a diamond daily.

Consideration [Middle of the Funnel]

Position with Bags, Phones, Watches. [If I carry a phone for 1L, Watch for 25K, Bag for 15K why am I wearing 2-4K INR worth of artificial jewellery?]

Why do I wear diamonds only on certain occasions? 99% of my life is non occasional.

Conversion [Bottom of the Funnel]

Hallmark Certificate, Easy Returns, Other Guarantees. [Optional: Try at Home services]

Limited Buying Window: Each design is available only for one week, with a countdown timer below. The design is then marked sold out / next available few months later.

This reduces choice fatigue and gives them a reason to come back if they like a design that is currently not available. It also helps in creating hype for upcoming designs.

Community Building

Celebrating women everyday. "Daily Diamond Club" / Styling suggestions. People could ask in the group, what design goes with which set of clothing.

Challenges

1. Creating awareness and information around the category
2. Creating trust for an online / new brand with no traction for expensive purchases costing >Rs. 30,000 (>\$300)
3. Establishing design supremacy.

Success Metrics

1. Offline Sales Conversions [First 20 Orders]
2. Website Traffic coming via LinkedIn [FLG]
3. Track CAC & Contribution Margins

